

Reflection on Digital Safety

While researching cybercrime aimed at college students, I was surprised by the psychological skill of modern scams, especially those involving UPI. I thought that "digital natives" would be naturally safe from online fraud. However, scammers often take advantage of the pressure that college life creates. They create a sense of urgency by threatening to cancel a valuable internship offer or by faking an emergency from a friend's cloned social media account. It became clear that being digitally literate doesn't protect someone from emotional manipulation.

Because of this research, I will change how I handle digital payments. I will no longer approve UPI requests without thinking. I am committing to a strict "pause and verify" rule: I will always remember that entering a UPI PIN is never needed to receive money, only to send it.